

Burp Suite – Target Tab and Site Map

Objective

The objective of this exercise is to understand the purpose of the **Target** tab and **Site Map** in Burp Suite.

Introduction

The Target tab provides an organized view of the web application's structure. Every HTTP request that passes through Burp Proxy is automatically recorded and displayed in the Site Map.

Instead of manually remembering every visited page, Burp creates a hierarchical map of the application. This helps penetration testers understand the application's attack surface before performing any security testing.

Understanding the Site Map

When a browser sends requests through Burp Proxy, Burp records information such as:

- Hostname
- Directories
- Pages
- API endpoints
- Static resources
- Dynamic resources

For example:

```
GET /  
GET /login  
POST /login  
GET /products  
GET /logout  
GET /api/user
```

All these requests become part of the Site Map.

Why the Site Map is Important

A penetration tester uses the Site Map to identify:

- Login pages
- Admin panels
- API endpoints
- Hidden directories
- Upload functionality
- Sensitive pages
- Static resources

This provides a complete overview of the target application before testing begins.

Practical Exercise

1. Launch a PortSwigger Web Security Academy Lab.
 2. Open Burp Suite.
 3. Enable the proxy.
 4. Browse different pages of the application.
 5. Open **Target** → **Site Map**.
 6. Observe how Burp automatically organizes discovered resources.
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Conclusion

The Target tab acts as a map of the web application. Professional penetration testers use it to understand the application's structure, identify interesting endpoints, and plan further security testing.

Screenshots

Screenshot 1:

WebSecurity Academy

SQL injection attack, querying the database type and version on Oracle

LAB Not solved

Back to lab home

Make the database retrieve the strings: 'Oracle Database 11g Express Edition Release 11.2.0.2.0 - 64bit Production, PL/SQL Release 11.2.0.2.0 - Production, CORE 11.2.0.2.0 Production, TNS for Linux: Version 11.2.0.2.0 - Production, NLSRTL Version 11.2.0.2.0 - Production'

Back to lab description

Home



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Are you a really, really bad dancer? Don't worry you're not alone. It is believed every 1 in 4 people are very bad at strutting their funky stuff. Here at 'Dancing In The Dark', we feel your pain. The silhouette suit which allows complete anonymity was originally designed by one of our interns fed up with her dad embarrassing her at local events. We loved the idea so much we decided to go into production straight away. The stretchy, breathable, fabric enables freedom of movement and guarantees a non-sweaty dancing experience. Easily put on and pulled off you can pop to the toilets and change at any time you want to dance without judgment. Once wearing your dancing skin it's best to avoid all contact with the people you arrived at the venue with, it might be a little too easy to identify you amongst family and friends. With this inexpensive, but very valuable, suit you can freestyle the night away without any inhibitions. If you spot someone making a fool of themselves, you can discreetly pass on our details as you get your Saturday Night Fever on. Let them talk about somebody else for a

Screenshot 2: Burp Target → Site Map

The screenshot displays the Burp Suite interface with the 'Target' tab selected. The 'Site map' sub-tab is active, showing a list of discovered hosts and their associated URLs. A table of requests and responses is visible, with the selected request details shown in the 'Request' pane.

Site Map Filter: Hiding not found items; hiding CSS, image and general binary content; hiding 4xx responses; hiding empty folders

Host	Met...	URL	Params	Status code	Length	MI
googleads.g.doubleclick.net	GET	/filter?category=Clothi...	✓	200	9129	HTI
static.doubleclick.net	GET	/filter?category=Corpo...	✓	200	9373	HTI
detectportal.firefox.com	GET	/filter?category=Food...	✓	200	8832	HTI
tracking-api.g2.com	GET	/resources/images/sh...		200	7258	XM
www.google.com	GET	/resources/labheader/...		200	8852	XM
www.googletagmanager.com	GET	/resources/labheader/...		200	942	XM
jnn-pa.googleapis.com	GET	/resources/labheader/...		200	1673	scri
jnn-pa.googleapis.com	GET	/filter				
firefox.settings.services.mozilla.com	GET	/filter?category=Lifest...	✓			
merino.services.mozilla.com	GET	/filter?category=Tour...	✓			
push.services.mozilla.com	GET	/academyLabHeader				
content-signature-2.cdn.mozilla.net	GET					
incoming.telemetry.mozilla.org	GET					
ps.containers.piwik.pro	GET					
ps.piwik.pro	GET					
phingest.portswigger.com	GET					
go.portswigger.net	GET					
portswigger.net	GET					
qvdt3feo.com	GET					
tags.srv.stackadapt.com	GET					
0a31001a041c9c368055441c00bd0047.web-security-academy.net	GET					
www.youtube.com	GET					
i.ytimg.com	GET					

Request Details:

```
1 GET /academyLabHeader HTTP/1.1
2 Host: 0a31001a041c9c368055441c00bd0047.web-security-academy.net
3 User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:152.0)
  Gecko/20100101 Firefox/152.0
4 Accept: */*
5 Accept-Language: en-US,en;q=0.9
6 Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate, br
7 Sec-WebSocket-Version: 13
8 Origin:
  https://0a31001a041c9c368055441c00bd0047.web-security-academy.net
9 Sec-WebSocket-Key: u7wKvpXKAioDEutKK2ejXw==
10 Connection: Upgrade
11 Cookie: session=QgvTxoSM1RuXnXwUHnTMFLzaoJRkRfj5
12 Sec-Fetch-Dest: empty
13 Sec-Fetch-Mode: websocket
14 Sec-Fetch-Site: same-origin
15 Pragma: no-cache
16 Cache-Control: no-cache
17 Upgrade: websocket
18
19
```

Inspector: Request, Response, Pretty, Raw, Hex, Inspector, Notes

Event log (2): All issues

Memory: 181.8MB of 3.64GB

Disabled: Disabled

Key Takeaways

- Burp automatically records visited resources.
- The Site Map represents the application's structure.

- Understanding the application structure is the first step of web application penetration testing.
 - Professional penetration testers always analyze the Site Map before beginning vulnerability assessment.
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Revision Questions

1. What is the purpose of the Target tab?
 2. What information does the Site Map contain?
 3. Why is the Site Map important during penetration testing?
 4. What types of endpoints can be discovered through the Site Map?
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